

all the other drives defragment properly. I even tried to defragment in Safe Mode, and ran Scandisk, but couldn't find any bad sectors. What do I do?

Ganesh Magal

users\Desktop). On pressing Cancel, I get another error message, "Fatal error during installation". The Auto-protect feature doesn't work, and I can't scan for viruses manually.

Digital Tools | Ask Agent 001

Jeep Kumar Dixit

A You can solve this problem by clicking on the desktop, and in the window that opens, click on Options > Yes.

Here under 'Show all files' and click 'Find Now' in the 'Name' drive. Check if it's found, and if not, you should

you will have to uninstall it, and then reinstall it. Download 'Msicuu.exe' from www.microsoft.com/download/office/MS/msicuu.exe. After installation, click Start > All Programs > Clean up. Here, click 'Remove' and then if this doesn't add the files, you need to edit a

registry key: 'Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall' and press the 'Find' button. Find the registry key: 'Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall'.

the product ID keys. To find the product ID keys, click each ID and look for the 'Product ID' in the right pane. On finding the product ID, delete it and exit the registry editor. You can now reinstall Norton.

Calling queries

Q I use a dial-up connection to the Internet. How do I know when someone is using my phone while I'm online? Can I set it up so that my connection to disconnect automatically when I receive a phone call?

Nataraj Das

A There's nothing you can do in Windows to get your PC to prompt you about incoming calls. However, you might be able to accomplish this if you tweak your modem. You need to have call waiting enabled—get in touch with your telephone service provider for this. If you set ATm2 in the modem settings box, the modem speakers will get a beep that indicates

A message from Nero

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.7 GHz on an 845 motherboard, a 40 GB Seagate Barracuda hard drive, and an LG 48X/16X/48X CD-RW, with Windows XP and Windows XP as my operating system. Recently, when I ran Nero 5.5.8.7, my PC hung and gave a message: 'IDE BUS... Please wait...'

A blackout sparks off Agent 001's search for the ideal UPS

UPS And Downs

Living on the outskirts of Mumbai, life's been smooth except for the sudden blackouts, which are an everyday nuisance. To make matters worse, a repeater transformer is located nearby making voltage spikes quite common.

I had relied solely on my spike-buster strip, until one fateful day. The useless thing gave way, blowing up my new Asus A7N8X motherboard and the Transcend memory modules as well.

Of course, both were covered under a warranty period and promptly replaced. But I had no intention of putting them back on; not with a useless spike-strip around. Obviously, I needed a UPS. Post a round of arguments with the Test Centre dudes, I had a clear idea of the type of UPS to look for - a 500 VA with a minimum of three power outlets and a backup time of at least 10 minutes.

Rather than go all the way to (yes, you guessed it) Lamington Road, I thought of trying my luck closer home in the shopping plazas at Vashi, Navi Mumbai. Here, the lowest price quoted was Rs. 2,000 for some local UPS brand, which went up to Rs. 3,200 for the good ones - but no one seemed happy selling these. Their general lack of interest put me off. No luck here, Lamington Road I had to go.

The dude in the first shop offered two choices - an Intex and a Powersafe priced at Rs 1,600 and Rs 2,200 respectively. Umm, *inme AVR hai kya?* Blank stares answered my question. Evidently, they had not heard of Automatic Voltage Regulation—a feature that reduces the possibility of burnouts and brownouts.

I moved out then, and into a shop off the

queerly named *Chunam Lane*. It was less of a shop and more of a swanky store, whose shelves showed off good quality hardware. And the guy behind the desk knew his wares. He offered me APC's Back UPS ES and explained all their features (AVR included). I was interested. The price though was a scalding Rs 2,850—expensive as compared to UPS solutions by Intex. *Aisa kyon?* He came the well-rehearsed reply, "*quality mangta hai to paisa dena padega, aap samajdar hein isliye mein ne appko quality maal dikhaya*" True (and he was quite right about me being smart, heh!), but I needed a balance of both, quality and *paisa*.

Hopping out, I skirted to the Q of Lamington Road. Q is a brand by himself. Well-known in the hardware circle to stock only the best products, he offered me options galore: UPSes from Wipro, TVSE and APC—all priced above Rs 2,500. Good products, I asked? He underlined the nature of the support provided by these companies for their products as the best reason to buy them, apart from the fact that the UPSes themselves are good at their job. If ever they go down, he said, help is just a call away. Well, this made sense to me and I asked him whether he had any personal favourites. "Yes", he spat out, "I do—APC and Wipro. The UPSes from these stables rock". He did have an extra good word to put in for APC though. Since APC has a good brand recall, Q said that he ended up selling them more than his other favourite.

That was all I needed to go with APC. A little bargain ensued and I got Q to come around to sell me the APC Back UPS ES at Rs 2,600. And yes, I also took down their service centre number.